

INNER STRUCTURES

A section down the middle of the brain reveals its inner structures. Although these structures look very different in the diagram below, they are all made up of brain tissue, which is composed of billions of neurons. There are two types of brain tissue – grey matter and white matter.

Cerebrum

Largest part of brain, with connections to all parts of the body

Hypothalamus

Functions include regulating body temperature and controlling autonomic nervous system

Meninges

Three membranes that surround and protect the brain and spinal cord; made up of connective tissue

Corpus callosum

Largest of several bundles of nerve fibres that connect the two brain hemispheres

Skull

Pituitary gland

Known as the "master gland"; controls many other glands

Thalamus

Area that relays nerve signals to cerebral cortex

Brainstem

Regulates vital functions such as heartbeat and respiration

Cerebellum

Second largest part of the brain; responsible for balance and posture; situated behind brainstem

